

Gelbach decomposition of age gradient

Federal income tax should be more progressive (Own survey, 2025)

78.8% explained, $\beta_{short} = -0.110$, $\beta_{full} = -0.023$, $N = 2,415$

tier 1 candidate variables: beliefs

#	Item	Contribution	% of explained
1	people get rich at others' expense, not by creating value	-0.045	52.5%
2	DEI creates opportunity for some at others' expense	-0.021	23.8%
3	CEO pay gains came at expense of average workers	-0.009	10.6%
4	higher taxes on high incomes make people work less	0.009	-10.2%
5	r's past hard work has paid off	-0.005	6.1%
6	harder or easier to move up now vs. parents' day	-0.005	5.4%

— 18 items with <5% contribution omitted —